

M. Hadi Amini, Ph.D.

Tenured Associate Professor of Computer Science · Knight Foundation School of Computing and Information Sciences
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Ph.D., Electrical & Computer Engineering, Carnegie Mellon University, 2019

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Tenured Associate Professor of Computer Science, Florida International University (FIU) 2025–present
Assistant Professor of Computer Science, FIU 2019–2025
Associate Director & FIU PI, U.S. DOT National Center for Transportation Cybersecurity and Resiliency (TraCR) 2023–present
Director & Principal Investigator, U.S. DHS-funded ADMIRE Center (Machine Learning-Driven Critical Infrastructure Resilience) 2023–2025
Affiliated Faculty, FIU Quantum Initiative (2026–) and Center for Integrated Security, Privacy & Trustworthy AI, CIERTA (2024–) · **Summer Visiting Faculty Fellow**, Air Force Research Laboratory / Information Directorate (2020) · **Ph.D. Fellow**, Carnegie Mellon University (2014–2019)

RESEARCH FUNDING

Over **\$8.3M** in total research funding (**\$3.16M as PI**) from DHS, NSF, U.S. DOT, AFRL, NOAA, and FL DoH/CDC across **13 awards as PI**, 5 as Co-PI, and 2 as Senior Personnel.

SELECTED AWARDS AND HONORS

2026 Faculty Research Excellence Award, FIU College of Engineering and Computing · Elevated to **Senior Member of ACM**
2025 IEEE Big Data Security Junior Research Award (IEEE Computer Society; one junior researcher recognized annually) · **Rising Star (Sciences)**, Academy of Science, Engineering and Medicine of Florida · Exemplary Editor Award, *IEEE Trans. on Machine Learning in Communications and Networking* · Excellence in Applied Research Award, Knight Foundation School of Computing and Information Sciences · Faculty Mentorship Award, FIU College of Engineering and Computing
2019–2024 FIU Top Scholar Award in Research and Creative Activities (2024) · Ranked among Elsevier’s **top 2% most-cited scientists** (2023) · U.S. DHS Scientific Leadership Award (2023) · FIU Faculty Excellence in Teaching Award (2023) · **Senior Member of IEEE** (2022) · Best Journal Paper Award, Springer Nature *Operations Research Forum* (2021) · AFRL Visiting Faculty Research Program Fellowship (2020) · Best Conference Paper Award, IEEE CSCI (2019) · Life Member, IEEE-Eta Kappa Nu Honor Society

PUBLICATIONS, PATENTS, AND IMPACT

Research advances distributed AI and optimization—federated learning, secure aggregation, and coupled learning—optimization for decision-making—to strengthen the security and resilience of cyber-physical systems, spanning connected transportation, power and water infrastructure, and post-disaster restoration, with results transitioned into granted patents, deployed tools, and federally funded research centers.
58 journal articles · **63** peer-reviewed conference and workshop papers · **10** authored/edited books (Springer, Wiley) · **9,500 citations**, **h-index 46** (Sept. 2026) · Erdős number 3 · **4 granted U.S. patents** and 6 filed/pending with the USPTO. Research featured in *USA TODAY*, *Fast Company*, *The Conversation*, *San Francisco Chronicle*, *NBC6*, and *Sun Sentinel* (2025–2026).

SELECTED RECENT PUBLICATIONS

- [1] M. Babaee, N. Saha, F. M. Ponce, S. Rezapour, and **M. H. Amini**, “Optimizing Post-Disaster Road Restoration with Reinforcement Learning: A Traveler-Behavior-Aware Approach,” *Reliability Engineering & System Safety*, 2026.
- [2] A. Devesa, D. Correa, C. Roa, R. Smith, **M. H. Amini**, and L. Bobadilla, “Event-Triggered Coverage Planning for Towable Sensing Systems,” *IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS)*, 2026.
- [3] E. Moore, A. Imteaj, M. Z. Hossain, S. Rezapour, and **M. H. Amini**, “Blockchain Empowered Cyber-Secure Federated Learning Framework for Trustworthy Edge Computing,” *IEEE Trans. on Artificial Intelligence*, 2025.
- [4] M. J. Mia and **M. H. Amini**, “QuanCrypt-FL: Quantized Homomorphic Encryption with Pruning for Secure Federated Learning,” *IEEE Trans. on Artificial Intelligence*, 2025.
- [5] B. C. Das, **M. H. Amini**, and Y. Wu, “Security and Privacy Challenges of Large Language Models: A Survey,” *ACM Computing Surveys*, 57(6), 2025.
- [6] A. Imteaj, U. Thakker, S. Wang, J. Li, and **M. H. Amini**, “A Survey on Federated Learning for Resource-Constrained IoT Devices,” *IEEE Internet of Things Journal*, 9(1), 2022 (450+ citations).

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE AND MEMBERSHIP

Associate Editor: *ACM Computing Surveys* (2026–), *IEEE Trans. on Information Forensics and Security* (2024–), *IEEE Trans. on Machine Learning in Communications and Networking* (2024–), *SN Operations Research Forum* (2020–2025); Editorial Board, *Smart Cities* · **Grant review panels**: NSF (10+ panels across CISE, ENG, EDU, TIP), DOE Early Career Research Program and ASCR, NIH, Austrian Science Fund, ORAU, COVA CCI · **TPC member** for 12+ conferences and workshops (ICDCS 2024, MILCOM 2026, ICCCN 2021, IEEE DSC/SCPS 2023) · Co-chair of three workshops/special sessions at IEEE ICMLA and UbiComp · Guest editor of five journal special issues · Reviewer for NeurIPS 2026, ICLR 2025, and 30+ journals · **Senior Member**, IEEE (2022–) and ACM (2026–).

MENTORING AND TEACHING

Advisor to **15 Ph.D. students** (7 graduated, 5 ABD), 45 Ph.D. committee memberships, 9 M.S. students, **17 undergraduate researchers**, and 7 NSF RET teachers. Alumni hold tenure-track faculty positions (Florida Atlantic, Dakota State, Coe College) and research roles at Savannah River National Laboratory, DLR, GE Vernova, AT&T, Microsoft, and Oracle. Designed FIU’s first linear algebra course for computing students (500+ enrolled); organizes the school’s CAREER Development Workshop Series and the Federated Education (FeEducation) webinar series.

Last updated: September 2026